

Code a Chatbot!

We are going to code a conversation with an alien!

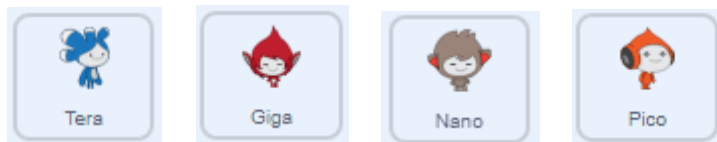


Full project instructions at <https://projects.raspberrypi.org/en/projects/chatbot>.

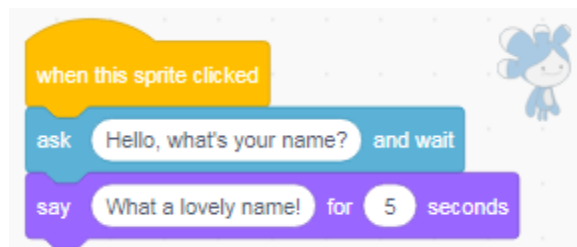
See the finished project at <https://scratch.mit.edu/projects/97864815/>.

Step 1: Choose your chatbot!

- These sprites are a good choice because they have several costumes, but it can be anyone you'd like to chat with:



- Choose a backdrop for your chatbot, where do they live?
- Now add this code, to start your chat:



- Click on your chatbot, and type a name (any name!) in the text box, then press the Enter key (or click the tick box).

Save your project

Step 2: Make it more personal

- Every time you type in a name, your chatbot says the same thing. What if they replied using the name you typed?

- We can do that using a variable that is already in Scratch:

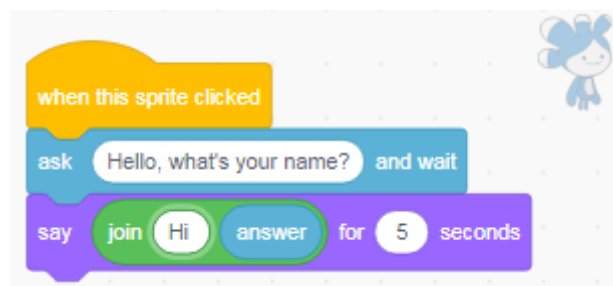
answer

- When we use the ask What's your name? and wait block, the answer variable stores whatever we type.

- If we want our chatbot to say 'Hi <your name>', then we also need the 'join' block from the 'Operators' section:

join apple banana

- So altogether the code looks like this:



- You will need to type a space after 'Hi', otherwise it will join up with your name!

Save your project

Step 3: Yes/No questions

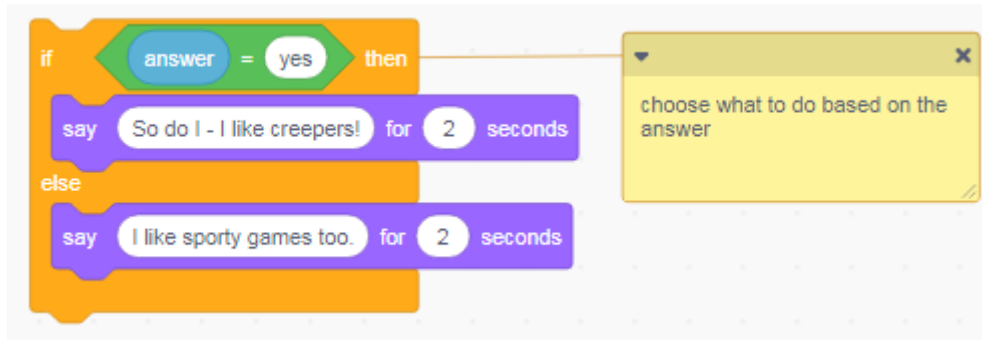
- Next, our chatbot will ask a question that has 'Yes' or 'No' for an answer, and do something different, depending on what we type!

- Think of a new question, here's mine:

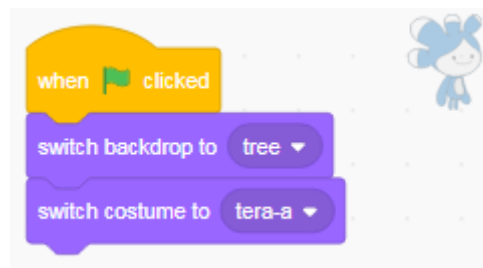
ask Do you play minecraft? and wait

- Add this block at the end of your code.

- Then add the 'if/else' block from the Control section, and add code for each answer, like this:



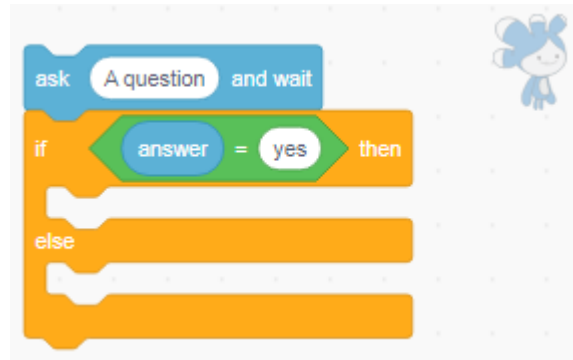
- You can also use different code blocks, to play a sound, change costume, make the chatbot move, or change the backdrop.
- Test your code twice – once when you type 'yes' and once when you type something else – does it work both times?
- If you changed your costume or the backdrop, you will need to reset them at the start of your project with another hat block, like this:



Save your project

Step 4: add your own questions

- What other questions can you think of to add?
- The basic blocks you need for a new question are these:



- Add blocks inside the 'if/else' to make different things happen.
- Remember to test both 'Yes' and 'No' answers!
- Ask a friend to chat to your chatbot, do they spot any bugs?

Save your project